

Potato Disease: Early Blight

Metadata

Crop: Potato
Disease: Early Blight
Scientific Name: *Alternaria solani*
Pathogen: Fungus
Source: ICAR, FAO

Overview

Early Blight is a fungal disease affecting potato leaves, causing characteristic concentric ring lesions and reducing yield.

Symptoms

Early: Small brown spots on older leaves.

Advanced: Dark lesions with concentric rings giving a target-like appearance.

Similar Diseases

Late Blight: water-soaked lesions.

Leaf Spot: smaller irregular spots.

Favorable Conditions

Warm temperatures (24–30°C), high humidity, nutrient stress.

Transmission

Spores spread via wind, water, and infected plant debris.

Management

Cultural: Crop rotation, remove infected debris.

Chemical: Mancozeb, chlorothalonil.

Prevention

Healthy seed tubers, balanced fertilization, proper spacing.

Severity

Mild: few lesions.

Severe: widespread defoliation and yield loss.

Recommended Action

Apply fungicides early and maintain field hygiene.

Source

ICAR: <https://icar.org.in>

FAO: <https://www.fao.org>